R&D | RetailPulse

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Stakeholder Needs and Demand Gathering

> **In simple words**
>
> Demand gathering means finding out what the business really needs before we start. We list who needs what and which decision each need supports.

1. Who cares about this project

A **stakeholder** is a person who uses or is affected by your work. This is a portfolio project, so the interviews are **simulated**. Write the answers as clearly marked assumptions.

Role	Main worry	Decision they make	What they need from us
Supply Chain Manager	Wrong order quantities	How much to order	Ranked list of high-error families, over and under direction
Category Manager	Empty shelves in key families	Safety stock by family	Shortfall units by family and month
Regional Manager	Some cities look worse	Where to give support	WAPE and Bias by state, city, store type
Planning Team	Holidays and promotions break the plan	Event planning	Error on holiday, payday, promotion days
Finance Manager	Cost of excess stock	Budget for stock	Excess units by family (money needs cost data)
You (Insights Analyst)	Giving advice nobody can use	What to recommend	Clean data and clear metric rules

2. Interview guide (8 questions)

#	Ask	Why we ask
1	What decision will you make with this analysis?	Links every result to an action
2	Which product families hurt most when forecast is wrong?	Sets priority
3	Is too much stock or empty shelves the bigger problem?	Decides which direction matters more
4	What error level is acceptable for a normal family?	Helps set the high-error rule
5	Which events change sales in your cities (holidays, paydays, local fairs)?	Gives hypotheses to test
6	How do you review forecast accuracy today?	Shows current pain
7	How often do you need the dashboard updated?	Sets refresh needs
8	What would make you trust this dashboard?	Sets quality rules

3. Requirements (what we must deliver)

ID	Requirement	Priority
R1	Overall WAPE, Accuracy %, Bias %	Must
R2	Ranking of families by WAPE and by share of total error	Must
R3	Over-forecast and under-forecast units by family	Must
R4	Error by state, city and store type	Must
R5	Error by month, holiday, payday, promotion	Must
R6	Written recommendations with owner and priority	Must
R7	Drill-through: daily actual vs forecast for one family	Should
R8	Comparison of two simple baselines by family	Should
R9	Oil price and transactions context	Could

4. KPI definitions agreed with stakeholders

KPI	Plain meaning	Defined in
WAPE	Total error divided by total actual sales	Doc 04
Accuracy %	1 minus WAPE	Doc 04
Bias %	Are we too high (+) or too low (-) overall	Doc 04
Excess units	Units forecast above actual	Doc 04
Shortfall units	Units actual above forecast	Doc 04
Error share %	How much of total error one group causes	Doc 04

5. Requirement log (fill this in)

ID	Stakeholder	Need (in their words)	Decision it supports	Priority	Where answered

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